ROALLA



EXECUTIVE ACQUISITION READINESS GUIDE

Acquisition Readiness and Value Creation Guide 2026

A decision framework for increasing buyer confidence protecting valuation and reducing transaction friction

Prepared for Canadian owners, boards, founders, chief executives, finance, technology, operations, legal, people and commercial leaders

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Purpose

This guide helps leadership prepare a company to attract credible strategic or financial acquirers while improving the business whether or not a transaction occurs. It connects the equity story, financial and revenue quality, growth, customer evidence, product and technology, intellectual property, cybersecurity, people, governance and diligence readiness into one value-creation program.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

A company becomes more attractive when its value can be verified, transferred, scaled and operated without hidden founder dependency or material control gaps. Management should build acquisition readiness before a process begins, using evidence that protects negotiating leverage and allows buyers to underwrite value with confidence.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Why should a buyer own this company?	**CONDITIONAL**	Define the strategic fit, differentiated assets, synergies and credible value-creation thesis.
Can buyers trust the earnings and growth story?	**PREPARE**	Reconcile financial, revenue, customer, pipeline and forecast evidence before outreach.
Is enterprise value transferable?	**CONDITIONAL**	Reduce founder, customer, employee, vendor, IP, platform and contract dependencies.
Can diligence proceed without surprises?	**DECIDE**	Resolve hard gaps, index evidence, align disclosures and establish accountable owners.
What should management authorize?	**PURSUE**	A 90-day acquisition-readiness diagnostic and prioritized value-protection plan.

Recommended Management Posture

Proceed through a small number of explicit decision gates. Preserve evidence as work occurs, separate discovery from implementation, and require each investment to demonstrate value, feasibility, control effectiveness and accountable ownership before scale.

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Acquisition Readiness Gates

Acquisition readiness is not a data-room exercise. A buyer must understand why the company is strategically valuable, believe the earnings and growth evidence, confirm that key assets and relationships can transfer, and see a manageable path through risk and integration. A material hard-gate failure can reduce valuation, change deal structure or stop a transaction.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Strategic value	Clear reason a buyer should own the company	Buyer thesis, differentiation, synergies and credible narrative
02	Financial quality	Reliable results and defensible normalization	Reconciled statements, forecasts, working capital and tax evidence
03	Revenue quality	Durable, transferable and measurable demand	Cohorts, retention, concentration, contracts and pipeline evidence
04	Market and growth	Defensible position with credible expansion	Market evidence, win loss, pricing, channels and growth plan
05	Product technology IP	Scalable assets owned and controlled	Architecture, roadmap, debt, security, IP chain and licences
06	Operations and people	Repeatable delivery beyond key individuals	Processes, metrics, succession, incentives and retention plan
07	Governance and risk	Material obligations are known and managed	Corporate, legal, privacy, cyber, regulatory and control evidence
08	Transaction readiness	Evidence and decision rights support a process	Data room, advisors, approvals, disclosure and integration view

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



Readiness Dimensions

Dimension	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Equity story	Strategic fit, differentiation, synergies and buyer relevance	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
02	Financial and tax	Earnings quality, controls, cash, working capital and obligations	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
03	Commercial	Revenue durability, customers, pricing, pipeline and growth	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
04	Product technology and IP	Ownership, architecture, security, scalability and roadmap	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
05	Organization	Leadership, key-person risk, incentives, process and culture	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
06	Governance and transaction	Corporate records, contracts, risk, evidence and approvals	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Strategic value	Clear reason a buyer should own the company	Buyer thesis, differentiation, synergies and credible narrative
Financial quality	Reliable results and defensible normalization	Reconciled statements, forecasts, working capital and tax evidence
Revenue quality	Durable, transferable and measurable demand	Cohorts, retention, concentration, contracts and pipeline evidence
Market and growth	Defensible position with credible expansion	Market evidence, win loss, pricing, channels and growth plan
Product technology IP	Scalable assets owned and controlled	Architecture, roadmap, debt, security, IP chain and licences
Operations and people	Repeatable delivery beyond key individuals	Processes, metrics, succession, incentives and retention plan
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Transaction readiness	Evidence and decision rights support a process	Data room, advisors, approvals, disclosure and integration view

ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Value Quality and Transferability

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	The board has agreed why the company is strategically valuable and which buyer types could realize that value.	☐	☐	_____
A02	Three years of financial statements and monthly management accounts reconcile to source records and tax filings.	☐	☐	_____
A03	Revenue, ARR, MRR, bookings, churn, retention and pipeline definitions are documented and applied consistently.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Customer concentration, cohort retention, pricing, gross margin and renewal performance are visible and explained.	☐	☐	_____
A05	Material customer, channel and supplier relationships can transfer without unexpected consent or change-of-control barriers.	☐	☐	_____
A06	Forecast assumptions connect to historical conversion, capacity, contract evidence and accountable owners.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Product differentiation, roadmap, adoption and unit economics are supported by customer and operating evidence.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Architecture, scalability, reliability, technical debt and cybersecurity risks have current evidence and remediation plans.	☐	☐	_____
A09	Intellectual property ownership is documented across founders, employees, contractors, licences and third-party components.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Key-person dependencies have succession, delegated authority, documented processes and retention responses.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

Diligence and Transaction Readiness

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	The minute book, cap table, securities register, option records and significant-control information are complete.	☐	☐	_____
B02	Material contracts are indexed with renewal, termination, exclusivity, assignment and change-of-control terms summarized.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Tax filings, payroll, sales taxes, credits, incentives and unresolved positions have been reviewed by qualified advisors.	☐	☐	_____
B04	Privacy, cybersecurity, incident, insurance and regulatory obligations are documented with evidence of control operation.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Employment and contractor files include enforceable confidentiality, invention-assignment and restrictive provisions where appropriate.	☐	☐	_____
B06	Litigation, complaints, warranties, service credits and contingent liabilities are recorded with an approved disclosure position.	☐	☐	_____
B07	A permission-controlled data room has an index, document owners, freshness dates and one authoritative source per item.	☐	☐	_____
B08	Management can present the equity story and answer likely diligence questions consistently with supporting evidence.	☐	☐	_____
B09	The transaction team has decision rights, confidentiality rules, communications protocols and qualified legal, tax and financial advice.	☐	☐	_____
B10	Management has identified integration priorities, continuity risks, retention actions and the first one hundred days of ownership change.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Equity story	20%	Strategic fit, differentiation, synergies and buyer relevance	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Financial and tax	20%	Earnings quality, controls, cash, working capital and obligations	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Commercial	15%	Revenue durability, customers, pricing, pipeline and growth	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Product technology and IP	15%	Ownership, architecture, security, scalability and roadmap	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Organization	15%	Leadership, key-person risk, incentives, process and culture	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Governance and transaction	15%	Corporate records, contracts, risk, evidence and approvals	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	**PURSUE**	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	**PREPARE**	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	**MONITOR**	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Build buyer confidence before outreach by sequencing value creation, risk remediation, diligence evidence and transaction decisions.



READINESS OPERATING PLAN

Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Align	Confirm owner objectives, timing, buyer profiles, confidentiality, advisors and decision rights.	Approved readiness mandate
Days 16 to 35	Diagnose	Assess value drivers, evidence, dependencies, hard gates and likely buyer questions.	Readiness score and gap view
Days 36 to 55	Remediate	Prioritize financial, commercial, technology, IP, people and governance actions by value impact.	Value protection plan
Days 56 to 75	Prepare	Build the data-room index, management evidence, disclosure log and diligence response process.	Buyer-ready evidence base
Days 76 to 90	Authorize	Approve go or prepare posture, owners, investment, process guardrails and next review gate.	Executive readiness decision

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: close critical corporate, financial, tax, IP, privacy, security and contract gaps.
- Quarter 2: strengthen recurring revenue quality, margins, forecast evidence and the buyer-specific equity story.
- Quarters 3 and 4: reduce founder and customer dependencies, deepen leadership and prove scalable operations.
- Year 2: maintain an always-ready data room, refresh valuation evidence and evaluate market timing using current results.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA acts as the technology, commercialization and readiness advisor coordinating management, product, finance, legal, tax, security and transaction specialists. ROALLA does not replace qualified deal counsel or financial advisors. It creates the integrated fact base, priorities and operating evidence that allow those specialists and management to work efficiently while protecting enterprise value.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Acquisition readiness diagnostic	Score hard gates, surface value leakage and establish the management decision agenda.
Equity story and buyer thesis	Connect strategic fit, differentiation, synergies and growth evidence to likely buyer priorities.
Financial and commercial evidence	Align revenue definitions, customer cohorts, forecasts, margins and operating metrics.
Product technology and IP	Assess architecture, roadmap, technical debt, scalability, ownership and licensing exposure.
Cyber privacy and data	Coordinate control evidence, incident readiness, data obligations and remediation priorities.
Governance and data room	Structure the evidence index, ownership, freshness, disclosure log and response workflow.
Advisor and management coordination	Integrate legal, tax, accounting, people and transaction inputs into one plan.
Value creation assurance	Track remediation, challenge evidence and keep leadership ready for buyer scrutiny.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week acquisition-readiness diagnostic using this guide and management interviews.
- Buyer-confidence scorecard with hard gates, value leakage and prioritized remediation owners.
- Technology, product, IP, cyber and operational diligence evidence plan coordinated with professional advisors.
- Executive readout with a 90-day value-protection plan and an always-ready data-room roadmap.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Founder dependency	Value relies on one person for sales, product or operations.	Delegate authority, document processes and create succession evidence.
Revenue concentration	A customer or channel can materially change performance.	Quantify exposure, improve terms and build a diversification plan.
Earnings adjustments	Unsupported add-backs undermine buyer confidence.	Reconcile normalization to records and obtain advisor review.
IP ownership gap	Core code, brands, data or inventions may not transfer.	Complete chain-of-title, assignments, licences and usage evidence.
Technology risk	Debt, fragility or cyber gaps create price or escrow pressure.	Assess architecture, security and remediation with cost and timing.
Contract constraint	Consent or change-of-control terms delay or reduce the deal.	Inventory provisions and plan approvals before they are critical.
People disruption	Key employees leave or lose focus during a process.	Segment critical roles and design confidential retention actions.
Premature process	Outreach begins before evidence and issues are controlled.	Use readiness gates and resolve material gaps before market exposure.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

Corporations Canada corporate records and obligations. Official source — Official guidance on corporate records, registers, resolutions and financial-statement obligations for federal corporations.

Canada Revenue Agency selling a business. Official source — Official overview of selected tax, account, asset-allocation and GST HST considerations when selling a business.

Competition Bureau merger review process. Official source — Official overview of Canadian merger review, notification, information and timing considerations.

Investment Canada Act overview. Official source — Official overview of filing, net-benefit and national-security review considerations for non-Canadian investment.

Office of the Privacy Commissioner business transaction guidance. Official source — Official summary of privacy requirements affecting necessary personal-information use and disclosure in prospective business transactions.

Canadian Centre for Cyber Security baseline controls. Official source — Canadian baseline cyber controls for small and medium organizations.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.